WATCH RESERVE · INTERNAL DOCUMENTATION

The Free Valuation Pop-up Modal Pipeline

From first scroll to a completed valuation: how the homepage pop-up, the "Ask Me Later" Rebound path, and the Valuation Link landing page work together as a single two-stage lead capture funnel.

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Scope: watchreserve.co.uk homepage pop-up, /sell "Ask Me Later" reminder, /valuation-link landing page and form, associated Resend/Klaviyo/GA instrumentation.

1. Executive Summary

The pop-up modal is the entry point to a two-stage lead capture funnel, built around one principle: keep the barrier to entry as low as possible at the first touchpoint, then use that initial "yes" to justify asking for more detail at a second touchpoint.

- Stage 1 (low barrier): a homepage pop-up asking only for Full Name and Email. A visitor who is not ready to commit can instead choose "Ask Me Later," which reappears as a short "Rebound" form on the Sell page rather than losing the lead outright.
- Stage 2 (data capture): once a Stage 1 lead exists, Watch Reserve follows up with an email containing a link to a dedicated landing page, /valuation-link, which collects the fuller data set actually needed to produce a valuation — brand, model, condition, photos, and contact preferences.
- The gap between Stage 1 and the Stage 2 email is being split-tested at three delays — 5, 20, and 55 minutes — to find the send time that maximises Stage 2 completion.

> **WHY THIS STRUCTURE**
> Asking a cold, unengaged visitor for a full watch valuation on first contact sets the barrier too high and depresses top-of-funnel conversion. Asking a warm lead — someone who already said yes once — for more detail a few minutes later has a materially higher completion rate than asking for the same detail cold.

2. Stage 1 — The Homepage Pop-up Modal

2.1 Trigger Timing

The modal does not fire immediately on page load. It fires on whichever happens first: the visitor's first scroll, or a 6-second fallback timer.

- This is deliberate, and is standard practice among conversion-focused pop-ups: firing instantly interrupts the visitor before they have had a chance to see the hero section and absorb the core value proposition, which reads as intrusive and depresses both trust and conversion.
- Waiting for a scroll (or a short delay as a fallback for visitors who land and read without scrolling) signals that the visitor has actually engaged with the page, which improves both the perceived relevance of the offer and the modal's conversion rate.
- Once dismissed (via the close button or by submitting), the modal is suppressed for 24 hours via a localStorage flag, so a returning visitor within the same day is not shown the same offer repeatedly.

2.2 Messaging — The "Offer" Framing

The modal is deliberately written as a limited-time offer, not as a neutral request for information:

- Badge copy: "Limited Time Offer."
- Headline: "Free Same Day Valuation."
- Body copy anchors the offer to a specific month ("For the Month of September we are offering a Free Valuation..."), giving it a real expiry rather than an open-ended, low-urgency ask.

WHY "OFFER" FRAMING MATTERS FOR A POP-UP SPECIFICALLY

A pop-up is inherently an interruption — it asks the visitor to stop what they were doing. Framing that interruption as an exclusive, time-boxed benefit gives the visitor a reason to tolerate the interruption and creates urgency (a reason to act now, not later). This is the mechanism that makes pop-up conversion work at all; a neutral or purely informational modal ("Get a valuation") gives the visitor no reason to act immediately and converts markedly worse in practice.

2.3 The Short Form — Lowering the Barrier to Entry

The pop-up asks for only two pieces of information: Full Name and Email, plus an optional marketing-consent checkbox. A hidden honeypot field filters bot submissions without adding friction for real visitors.

- Every additional required field on a cold, unengaged visitor is another point at which they may abandon. Two fields keep the ask small enough that completing it is less effort than deciding to skip it.
- This short form is intentionally the entire point of Stage 1: it is not meant to capture enough detail to produce a valuation — that happens at Stage 2 — it exists purely to convert an anonymous visitor into an identified, contactable lead.

2.4 "Ask Me Later" — The Rebound Path

Beneath the main submit button sits a secondary, lower-commitment link: "Ask Me Later." Internally, a lead who takes this path is labelled a Rebound — they have not converted outright, but they have not been lost either; they are bounced forward into a second, later touchpoint rather than dropped.

- Clicking it sets a wr_ask_me_later flag in localStorage, fires a Google Analytics form_dismiss event tagged action: ask_me_later, and closes the modal under the same 24-hour suppression as a plain close.
- The flag is read once, and cleared immediately on read, so the Rebound reminder can only ever fire once per click — a visitor cannot be shown it repeatedly from a single "Ask Me Later" action.

2.5 Analytics Instrumentation (Stage 1)

- form_dismiss — fires when "Ask Me Later" is clicked (form_name: free_valuation_popup, action: ask_me_later).
- form_submit — fires on a successful pop-up submission (form_name: free_valuation_popup).

3. Stage 1b — The Rebound Slide-in Reminder (Sell Page)

3.1 When and Where It Appears

The Rebound flag set in section 2.4 is only ever consumed on the Sell page (/sell). On mount, the page checks for the flag; if present, a slide-in panel animates in from the bottom-left roughly 700ms after the page has finished loading.

- The delay is deliberate for the same reason as the pop-up's own trigger delay: it should read as a considered "welcome back," not as an instant, jarring re-interruption the moment the page paints.

3.2 It Is a Form, Not Just a Link

Originally, the Rebound reminder's call to action simply scrolled the visitor to the full 3-step Sell form. It has since been rebuilt to reproduce the same short capture as the original pop-up directly inside the panel: Full Name, Email, and the marketing-consent checkbox, visible immediately with no extra click required to reveal them.

- Copy: "You asked us to check back. The form below takes 30 seconds, with no obligation to sell." — deliberately framed as even lower-effort ("30 seconds") than the original pop-up's framing ("two minutes"), since this is a second chance at the same low-friction ask and should feel like the path of least resistance.

3.3 Submission & Source Tagging

The Rebound form submits to the same /api/free-valuation endpoint used by the main pop-up, but tags the submission with source: "Ask Me Later Reminder · Homepage Popup." This source string flows through to three places:

- The internal Watch Reserve notification email — shown as a clearly labelled badge, so staff can immediately tell a Rebound lead apart from a direct pop-up conversion.
- The plain-text version of that same internal email and its footer line.
- The Klaviyo profile sync, as the last_form_source custom property — which is what will drive the Stage 2 send-time test (see section 4.2).

> **CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE STAYS IDENTICAL**
> Regardless of which Stage 1 path a lead came through — direct pop-up or Rebound — the customer-facing confirmation email they receive is byte-for-byte the same template and content. The source distinction exists only for Watch Reserve's internal reporting; customers never see a difference in their own experience.

- form_submit — fires on a successful Rebound submission (form_name: ask_me_later_reminder), distinct from the pop-up's own form_submit event so the two paths can be measured separately.

4. Stage 2 — The Valuation Link Email & Landing Page

4.1 Purpose

Once a lead exists from Stage 1 (via either the pop-up or the Rebound path), Watch Reserve sends a follow-up email containing a link to /valuation-link — a dedicated landing page built to capture the fuller data set actually required to produce a valuation: brand, model, reference, year, condition, box/papers, photos, and full contact details.

This is the second half of the low-barrier strategy: because the visitor has already said yes once at effectively no cost, asking for a longer form now converts at a materially higher rate than asking a cold visitor for the same detail on first contact.

4.2 Send-Time Split Test — 5 / 20 / 55 Minutes

Watch Reserve will test sending the Valuation Link email at three different delays after a Stage 1 submission: 5 minutes, 20 minutes, and 55 minutes.

- Hypothesis: too fast can feel automated and impersonal, and may arrive before the lead is back at a computer or has re-engaged; too slow risks losing the moment of intent that drove the original submission. The three-way test is designed to find the delay that maximises Stage 2 open and completion rate.

> **IMPLEMENTATION STATUS: NOT YET BUILT**
> This delayed send does not exist in the codebase today — every current email fires synchronously, immediately on submission. The syncToKlaviyo() call already attaches a last_form_source property to the Klaviyo profile on every Stage 1 submission (pop-up or Rebound), which is the natural trigger for a time-delayed flow. Recommend building the 5/20/55-minute test as a Klaviyo flow (using Klaviyo's native time-delay branches and A/B split-testing) rather than a custom cron or queue, since the trigger data already exists.

4.3 Measuring Pop-up vs. Rebound Separately

Because the source tag already distinguishes a direct pop-up submission from a Rebound submission (section 3.3), the send-time test — and all future analysis of which Stage 1 path converts better at Stage 2 — can be run and reported on separately for each path, not just in aggregate.

5. The Valuation Link Landing Page

5.1 A Dedicated, Isolated Funnel Page

On the /valuation-link route only, the standard site navigation bar is replaced entirely. The Shop / Sell / Source / Blogs / Intelligence / Contact links, the search bar, the wishlist icon, the cart icon, and the mobile burger menu are all hidden and replaced with a single line of offer copy — "September Free Valuation Offer" — next to the logo. The logo itself is not a clickable link on this page; clicking it does nothing.

> **WHY THE NAVIGATION IS DELIBERATELY CRIPPLED HERE**
> This page exists for exactly one purpose: get the lead who clicked through from their Stage 2 email to complete the valuation form. Every nav link, every path back to the shop or homepage, is an exit ramp out of the funnel the email specifically drove the visitor into. Removing them — including the usual "click the logo to go home" escape hatch — keeps the visitor's only meaningful action on the page "complete the form."

5.2 The 3-Step Form & Personalised Section Titles

The form is split into three steps, each now carrying its own heading rather than one generic form title:

- Step 1 — "Tell Us About Your Watch": brand, model, reference number, year.
- Step 2 — "The Condition of the Watch": condition, box, papers, photos.
- Step 3 — "Tell Us About You": name, email, phone, preferred contact method, marketing consent.

Each title sits inline with a compact "Step X of 3" progress indicator on desktop (stacking underneath it on mobile, where a full-width bar would otherwise dominate the form).

WHY TITLING EACH SECTION IS A PERSONALISATION LEVER
Naming each section turns the form into something closer to a guided conversation — first about "your watch," then about "you" — rather than one undifferentiated wall of fields. It also gives the visitor a concrete sense of progress and structure, which reduces the perceived effort of a multi-step form even though the field count hasn't changed.

The Model field is also brand-aware: selecting "Rolex" swaps the free-text Model input for a dropdown pre-populated with the most common references (Submariner, Datejust, Day-Date, GMT-Master II, Daytona, Explorer, Sea-Dweller, Yacht-Master, and others, plus "Other"). Every other brand keeps the free-text field. Rolex was chosen specifically because it drives the largest share of submissions, and a constrained dropdown reduces typos and ambiguous free-text answers for exactly that volume.

5.3 Recommendation: Consolidate to a 2-Step Form

The current 3-step structure was built for clarity, and the new per-step titles help justify it — but every additional step in a multi-step form is another point at which a visitor can stop partway through and never finish.

- With personalised section titles now in place, there is a reasonable case for combining the current Step 1 and Step 2 (all of the watch-detail fields — brand, model, reference, year, condition, box, papers, photos) into a single "About Your Watch" step, leaving "Tell Us About You" as the second and final step.
- Recommend split-testing the existing 3-step version against a 2-step version with identical fields and copy, rather than assuming fewer steps is strictly better: reducing steps typically raises completion rate, but can also reduce per-field data quality if visitors move faster and skip optional detail. This should be measured on Watch Reserve's own traffic, not assumed from general best practice.

5.4 Mobile-Specific Refinements

- The native browser dropdown arrow on the Brand select rendered inconsistently across mobile browsers (often positioned too far right); replaced with a fixed custom chevron so it looks identical on every device.
- The step progress bar previously spanned the full width of the form card, reading as visually heavy on a small screen; it now sits inline beside the step title on desktop and stacks underneath it on mobile.
- The primary "Continue / Submit" button colour was brought in line with the Contact page's button (gold, matching the site's primary brand accent) for visual consistency across all lead-capture forms.

6. Consistency & Data Integrity Notes

- Preferred Contact Method (Phone / Email / WhatsApp) is optional at every step of both the Sell page and the Valuation Link page — no submission is blocked by leaving it unselected.
- The customer-facing confirmation email is identical in content and template regardless of which Stage 1 entry point (pop-up vs. Rebound) a lead came through; only Watch Reserve's internal notification email differs, via the source badge.

- Every lead-capture endpoint (pop-up, Rebound, Sell, Valuation Link) shares the same honeypot pattern, the same email-validation logic, and syncs to the same Klaviyo profile store, so a given email address accumulates a consistent, mergeable history across every touchpoint it passes through.

7. Analytics Instrumentation Summary

All events below are Google Analytics events, fired only once GA consent has been granted.

Event	Fires when	Key parameters
form_dismiss	Visitor clicks "Ask Me Later" on the homepage pop-up	form_name: free_valuation_popup action: ask_me_later
form_submit	Homepage pop-up submitted successfully	form_name: free_valuation_popup
form_submit	Rebound slide-in reminder (Sell page) submitted successfully	form_name: ask_me_later_reminder

8. Recommendations & Roadmap

Beyond the split tests already planned (send-time delay, 2-step vs. 3-step form), the following gaps and opportunities are worth flagging:

8.1 Terminology alignment

- The business vocabulary for this flow uses "Rebound" for an Ask Me Later lead, but the code and Klaviyo/GA data currently label the same path "Ask Me Later Reminder · Homepage Popup." Recommend aligning the tracked source label to literally include "Rebound" so future dashboards and reporting match the terminology used internally and in this document — right now the two vocabularies don't quite match, which will cause confusion once someone else is reading the analytics without this context.

8.2 Additional trigger coverage

- The pop-up currently triggers only on first scroll or a 6-second timeout. Consider adding an exit-intent trigger (mouse movement toward the browser chrome on desktop, a back-navigation gesture on mobile) as a second capture opportunity for visitors who read the page without ever scrolling.

8.3 Attribution

- Neither Stage 1 payload currently captures UTM parameters or referrer. Adding this would let the eventual Klaviyo send-time flow — and all future reporting — attribute Stage 1 conversions to the marketing channel that actually drove them, not just to "pop-up" vs. "Rebound."

8.4 De-duplication

- There is currently no check for whether a lead who converts at Stage 1 has already, independently, submitted a full valuation via /sell or /valuation-link. Worth a lightweight check before the Stage 2 email fires, so a lead isn't sent a redundant "complete your valuation" email for a valuation they've already completed through another route.

8.5 Outstanding verification

- The mobile-specific pop-up sizing (90% of the viewport) and the compacted mobile header/section spacing described in section 5.4 have been implemented but not yet visually verified on a real device or browser session. Recommend a manual pass on both iOS and Android viewport sizes before this goes fully live.

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